

MINI HACK • COHORT 2 • GAME JAM

Building Gamified **Systems** for Business, Natively on Avalanche

12 hours. Working prototypes. No exceptions on what counts as done.

PROBLEM
STATEMENTS

10

FORMAT

6:00 PM – 6:00
AM

FRAMEWORK

Routledge's Six
Principles

REGION

Team1 East
Africa

INTRODUCTION

Why Tonight Is Different

Tonight is 12 hours — 6:00 PM to 6:00 AM. By sunrise, every team should have a working prototype deployed natively on Avalanche, not a slide deck describing one.

Cohort 1's bounty programme (Kuzana x MiniHack) proved builders will rise to a real, well-structured brief. Tonight borrows that same structure — but the brief itself is different. Cohort 1 asked builders to solve **operational** problems for one SME accelerator. Tonight asks builders to solve **engagement** problems across ten business niches, using the actual mechanics of why games work — Helen Routledge's six principles: **Choice, Feedback, Pacing, Practice, Enjoyment, Readiness**.

A badge is not a game mechanic. A leaderboard with no consequence is not a game mechanic. Tonight's bar is higher than that.

IDENTIFIED GAPS FROM COHORT 1

What's Different Tonight

01 Generic judging criteria. Round 1 judged everything on Problem Understanding / Solution Quality / User Feedback / Execution — useful for operational tools, but it never tested whether a gamified mechanic was well-designed. Tonight, judging is Routledge-native: the six principles *are* the rubric.

02 No signature teaching focus per bounty. Round 1's six bounties differed by domain but not by design discipline. Tonight, each of the ten problem statements has a **signature principle** builders are specifically pushed to nail — so the cohort collectively builds range across all six.

03 Multi-week reward structure doesn't fit a single night. Round 1 spanned June to August. Tonight compresses build, submit, and shortlist into the same 12 hours.

Flag before publishing: what happens after tonight's shortlist — direct roll-in to the Hack House Gaming track, or a separate Stage 2 event — still needs confirming.

BY THE NUMBERS

Tonight's Context

10

Problem statements across business niches

6

Routledge principles judged in every submission

30

Finalist teams at Hack House, September 2026

\$2K

Gaming track bounty pool at Hack House Demo Day

HOW TONIGHT WORKS

Run of Show

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	WHEN
Build	Teams pick one of the ten problem statements and build a working, on-chain prototype.	8:00 PM – 4:30 AM
Freeze & Submit	Deployment freeze — no new features. Teams submit via Plug and Play.	4:30 AM – 5:00 AM
Demo & Shortlist	3-minute lightning demos, on-chain proof visible on screen. Facilitators shortlist standout builds per principle.	5:00 AM – 5:45 AM

The One Non-Negotiable Gate

Same standard as every MiniHack cohort: **demo ≠ product**.

STEP	WHAT IT IS	WHY
1. On-chain deployment	A verifiable deployment natively on Avalanche — a contract address or transaction judges can check themselves.	A screenshot or local test proves nothing. This is the one non-negotiable gate.
2. Screen recording	A 1-minute recording showing the prototype running, with on-chain proof visible on screen.	Verifies functionality reliably, without needing a live link to still be up.
3. Lightning demo	3 minutes, live, at 5:00 AM.	Lets facilitators assess whether the team understands why their mechanic works, not just that it runs.

Working software, deployed on-chain, is the standard. A great gamification concept with nothing built behind it does not advance.

THE TEN PROBLEM STATEMENTS

Signature Principles at a Glance

#	NICHE	SIGNATURE PRINCIPLE
01	Payments & Fintech Retention	Choice
02	Retail & SME Loyalty	Pacing
03	Logistics & Last-Mile Delivery	Feedback
04	Agricultural Value Chains	Readiness
05	Health & Community Adherence	Enjoyment
06	Education & Skills Credentialing	Practice
07	Micro-Insurance Engagement	Choice
08	Rent-to-Own & Property Savings	Pacing
09	Community Events & Participation	Feedback
10	Circular Economy & Waste Collection	Enjoyment + Practice

PROBLEM 01 — Payments & Fintech Retention

SIGNATURE: CHOICE

PROBLEM

Stablecoin and cross-border payment products get tried once and abandoned. Users have no reason to make it a habit.

CHALLENGE

Build a gamified system where users face real, consequential choices about how they save, spend, or move money — not a single linear “next” — and where good choices are rewarded on-chain.

SKILLS REQUIRED

Smart contract development, wallet integration, basic reward-mechanic design.

COMMON PITFALL

Defaulting to points-for-login. A choice only counts if it has a consequence the user can feel — reward the decision, not the click.

DELIVERABLES

- On-chain mechanic with at least two meaningfully different paths a user can take
- Visible consequence tied to each path
- Retention metric tracked

SUCCESS

A user can explain, unprompted, what they chose and why it mattered.

QUEST Choice-Driven Payments Loop

VERIFICATION on-chain address + 1-min recording

XP [TBD]

PROBLEM 02 — Retail & SME Loyalty

SIGNATURE: PACING

PROBLEM

Small retail businesses have no low-cost way to turn a first-time buyer into a repeat one.

CHALLENGE

Build a gamified loyalty mechanic where rewards escalate over time — easy wins early, harder (and more valuable) milestones later — issued on-chain as tokens or NFTs.

SKILLS REQUIRED

Smart contract development, simple purchase-tracking integration.

COMMON PITFALL

Flat rewards that don't escalate. If milestone 10 feels the same as milestone 1, there's no pacing — just repetition.

DELIVERABLES

- On-chain loyalty mechanic with at least 3 escalating tiers
- Clear signal to the user of what tier they're in and what's next

SUCCESS

A shop owner can point to increasing purchase frequency and trace it to specific tier unlocks.

QUEST Tiered Loyalty Engine

VERIFICATION on-chain address + 1-min recording

XP [TBD]

PROBLEM 03 — Logistics & Last-Mile Delivery

SIGNATURE: FEEDBACK

PROBLEM

Delivery riders get paid per drop with no real-time signal on how they're actually performing.

CHALLENGE

Build a gamified system giving riders continuous feedback — not just “great job” — tied to on-chain incentive payouts for speed, reliability, and completed drops.

SKILLS REQUIRED

Smart contract development, basic geolocation or delivery-status integration.

COMMON PITFALL

Ego-level feedback only (“Nice work!”). Riders need to know how they're doing and what to change next — task and process feedback, not just praise.

DELIVERABLES

- On-chain payout mechanic
- Feedback surface answering “how am I doing” and “what should I do differently” in real time

SUCCESS

A rider can explain what to do next time to earn more, because the feedback made it obvious — not because someone told them.

QUEST Real-Time Rider Feedback Loop

VERIFICATION on-chain address + 1-min recording

XP [TBD]

PROBLEM 04 — Agricultural Value Chains

SIGNATURE: READINESS

PROBLEM

Smallholder farmers have no incentive to submit verified harvest or quality data — and most tools assume smartphone fluency they don't have.

CHALLENGE

Build a gamified traceability system rewarding verified on-chain data submission, designed for users who may have low connectivity, low literacy, or no prior crypto exposure.

SKILLS REQUIRED

Smart contract development, low-bandwidth/SMS or voice interface design.

COMMON PITFALL

Assuming a token alone motivates submission. If the interface itself is the barrier, no reward fixes that — readiness comes first.

DELIVERABLES

- On-chain incentive mechanic
- An interface a first-time user with no crypto background can complete unassisted

SUCCESS

A cooperative member with zero prior crypto exposure completes the loop without help.

QUEST Farmer-Ready Traceability Loop

VERIFICATION on-chain address + 1-min recording

XP [TBD]

PROBLEM 05 — Health & Community Adherence

SIGNATURE: ENJOYMENT

PROBLEM

Health-check and community-reporting programmes have low, unverifiable repeat participation — they feel like homework.

CHALLENGE

Build a gamified adherence system with on-chain proof-of-participation that people actually want to open a second time.

SKILLS REQUIRED

Smart contract development, basic reporting workflow integration.

COMMON PITFALL

Compliance tracking dressed up as a game. If it isn't genuinely enjoyable, badges won't save it.

DELIVERABLES

- On-chain proof-of-participation mechanic
- A real fun factor — not just a streak counter

SUCCESS

Participants return for round two and three without being reminded.

QUEST Adherence That Doesn't Feel Like Homework

VERIFICATION on-chain address + 1-min recording

XP [TBD]

PROBLEM 06 — Education & Skills Credentialing

SIGNATURE: PRACTICE

PROBLEM

Skills training has no safe space to fail — one wrong answer on a certificate exam and the learner is done, with no path to improve.

CHALLENGE

Build a gamified skills-credentialing system where users can retry, improve, and eventually earn a verifiable on-chain credential once they demonstrate real competence.

SKILLS REQUIRED

Smart contract development (verifiable credentials/NFT certificates), basic assessment logic.

COMMON PITFALL

One-shot testing disguised with a game skin. Practice means real retry loops with visible improvement, not just a prettier exam.

DELIVERABLES

- On-chain credential issued only after demonstrated competence
- A retry loop that shows the learner improving over attempts

SUCCESS

A learner who failed their first attempt can point to exactly what improved by attempt three.

QUEST Retry-to-Mastery Credential

VERIFICATION on-chain address + 1-min recording

XP [TBD]

PROBLEM 07 — Micro-Insurance Engagement

SIGNATURE: CHOICE

PROBLEM

Micro-insurance products are opaque — users don't understand what their behavior does to their premium or coverage, so they disengage.

CHALLENGE

Build a gamified system where users make real, transparent choices about coverage or risk behavior, with on-chain visibility into how those choices affect their standing.

SKILLS REQUIRED

Smart contract development, basic risk/premium logic.

COMMON PITFALL

Hiding the mechanics behind a black box. If users can't see how their choice changed their outcome, it isn't a meaningful choice.

DELIVERABLES

- On-chain mechanic showing at least two coverage/behavior paths with visibly different, transparent consequences

SUCCESS

A user can explain in their own words how their choice changed their premium or coverage — because the system showed them.

QUEST Transparent Coverage Choices

VERIFICATION on-chain address + 1-min recording

XP [TBD]

PROBLEM 08 — Rent-to-Own & Property Savings

SIGNATURE: PACING

PROBLEM

Long-horizon savings goals (rent-to-own, property deposits) feel abstract and unmotivating — there's no sense of progress until the very end.

CHALLENGE

Build a gamified savings mechanic that breaks a long-horizon property goal into escalating, on-chain-verified milestones that feel achievable along the way.

SKILLS REQUIRED

Smart contract development, savings/escrow logic.

COMMON PITFALL

One giant goal with no intermediate markers. Pacing means the middle of the journey needs its own visible wins, not just the finish line.

DELIVERABLES

- On-chain savings mechanic with at least 4 milestone markers between start and goal
- Visible progress signal at each one

SUCCESS

A saver can point to a specific milestone and say what it unlocked or proved.

QUEST Milestone-Paced Property Savings

VERIFICATION on-chain address + 1-min recording

XP [TBD]

PROBLEM 09 — Community Events & Participation

SIGNATURE: FEEDBACK

PROBLEM

Community programmes (workshops, cohorts, meetups) struggle to show members where they stand — attendance is tracked, but nobody can see “how am I doing” or “what’s next.”

CHALLENGE

Build a gamified participation-tracking system, on-chain, that gives community members continuous feedback on their engagement and a clear next step.

SKILLS REQUIRED

Smart contract development, basic event/attendance data integration.

COMMON PITFALL

A leaderboard with no “why.” Ranking alone isn’t feedback — it needs to answer where am I going, how am I doing, where next.

DELIVERABLES

- On-chain participation mechanic
- A feedback surface answering all three of Routledge’s core feedback questions

SUCCESS

A community member can state, without being told, what their next step is to level up.

QUEST Three-Question Participation Feedback

VERIFICATION on-chain address + 1-min recording

XP [TBD]

PROBLEM 10 — Circular Economy & Waste Collection

SIGNATURE: ENJOYMENT + PRACTICE

PROBLEM

Recycling and waste-collection incentive programmes get tried once and abandoned — there's no fun in it, and no easy way to improve your technique.

CHALLENGE

Build a gamified collection/recycling incentive system, on-chain, that's genuinely enjoyable to repeat and lets users improve their sorting/collection behavior over time.

SKILLS REQUIRED

Smart contract development, basic collection/verification workflow.

COMMON PITFALL

A points-per-drop system with no personality. If it feels like a chore with a token attached, it will get abandoned exactly like the programmes before it.

DELIVERABLES

- On-chain incentive mechanic
- A genuine enjoyment hook
- A visible way for users to improve their behavior over repeated attempts

SUCCESS

Participants come back a third and fourth time without a reminder, and can point to how their approach improved.

QUEST Enjoyable Repeat Recycling Loop

VERIFICATION on-chain address + 1-min recording

XP [TBD]

APPLIES TO EVERY PROBLEM STATEMENT

The Rules, No Exceptions

- ✓ **Demo ≠ product.** Every submission must be a verifiable on-chain deployment, natively on Avalanche. No local tests, no screenshots.
- ✓ Talk to at least 2 real users or stakeholders about the problem before or during the build — even a WhatsApp voice note counts tonight. Note who and what surprised you in your submission.
- ✓ Submit through Plug and Play, not a written report.
- ✓ The winner is whoever nails their signature principle *and* the on-chain gate — not whoever ships the most features.
- ✓ Builders retain full ownership and credit for what they build.
- ✓ Team1 and Avalanche may feature standout builds publicly as case studies.

HOW SUBMISSIONS ARE JUDGED

Scoring — Routledge's Six Principles

Gate — pass/fail, checked first: Is it a verifiable native Avalanche deployment? If not, disqualified regardless of design quality.

Choice		15%
	Real, consequential decisions — not a linear "next."	
Feedback		20%
	Answers where am I going / how am I doing / where next. Ego-praise alone scores low.	
Pacing		15%
	Difficulty or milestones escalate without frustration or boredom.	
Practice		15%
	Users can fail safely and retry, visibly improving.	
Enjoyment		20%
	Genuinely fun — not gamification theatre.	
Readiness		15%
	Meets non-crypto-native users at their actual context.	

Plus: each submission gets a bonus note on how well it executed its signature principle specifically — this is what separates the shortlist from the rest.

PLUG AND PLAY SETUP NOTES

For Whoever's Loading This Tonight

- ✓ Each of the 10 problem statements = one quest. Quest name given on each problem statement's quest card.
- ✓ Verification method for every quest is identical: on-chain contract/transaction address + 1-minute screen recording link.
- ✓ XP/point values are placeholders — confirm the scoring scale before publishing so all 10 quests are weighted consistently.
- ✓ Suggested tagging: niche name + "GameJam" + "Cohort2" for tracking on the quest tracker (minihacktracker.vercel.app).

